



and are not good enough. But those are only doubts that you have in yourself.

As an athlete, you win or lose, and that's part of the sport. Before I won the Olympics in London in 2012, I competed in Beijing in 2008 and didn't even make the final. I was devastated and felt like I had let so many people down. But I had to wait another four years to prove I was still good enough and capable of winning medals.

So, when you lose a race, it's important for you to understand the race, how you lost, what you could have done differently, whether you under-trained or over-trained. Perhaps could you have run at a bit more speed or tactically, did you get the race wrong? It's all learning. As an athlete, you never stop learning.

Mentally how did you handle that phase between the Beijing Games and the London Olympics?

For athletes, it's always been hard on mental health. Athletes are the

No.1 faces of mental health challenges. In terms of mental health, now we can openly talk about it because we have the platform, and a lot of people are coming forward to talk about it as we recognise this is a problem.

But an athlete was traditionally seen as the hardest guy. You could never talk about it (mental health). Even when you doubted yourself, you had to show bravery in front of the camera, and that was part of the image.

But now, there's a space where we can talk about it. And for me, it's important for us to understand that they are all just human. We all face these challenges, and we can overcome them. When you are an athlete and things haven't gone well, it's important to understand and see what you could do to fix it.

You need to recognise that maybe the other guy has a bit more talent, or perhaps they've put in a bit more hard work, and that's why you could not make it against them.

On the move: Around 60,000 runners participated in the event. Berhane Tesfay of Eritrea won the men's title while Kenya's Joyce Chepkemoi Tele took the women's crown.

EMMANUEL YOGINI

Sometimes, I've gone into races feeling like I should have won, but I didn't because the better man won on the day. That is the reality. For a champion athlete, it also takes a great deal of preparation.

An athlete makes a lot of sacrifices to achieve something and that means staying away from family, following a strict diet, living a regimented life, and, despite all that, managing pressure. How does one handle it?

That's part of being an athlete. If you want to be the best, you've got to question yourself, "How can I be the best? What can I do? What are my opponents doing?" For me, I had no choice. If I wanted to be the best,